

D808

General Secondary Methods

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A geography teacher who recently earned a master's degree writes the objective: Students will compare the climates of two regions using data. The planned activity is a colorful map-coloring worksheet, and the assessment is a labeling quiz. Students love the worksheet. What is the main problem?

- A. The quiz needs more items.
- B. The objective should be rewritten to match the labeling quiz.
- C. The activity and assessment do not practice or measure comparing climates with data.
- D. The worksheet is too enjoyable to be rigorous.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An assessment asks students to write a letter to a city council arguing for a policy, using two data sources. Which objective does it align with?

- A. Students will list the members of the city council.
- B. Students will construct an argument for a policy using evidence from data sources.
- C. Students will write a friendly letter using correct format.
- D. Students will define the word policy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

An art history teacher who spent a summer in Italy asks: Evaluate the painting by listing the three colors the artist used. The question appears on a new district-designed template. At what cognitive level is the task actually working?

- A. Remember.
- B. Create, because it involves art.
- C. Analyze, because it is on a district template.
- D. Evaluate, because the question uses the word evaluate.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A math teacher who coaches the chess team writes a unit test on solving linear equations. Every item is a long word problem with advanced vocabulary. Many English learners who solve equations correctly in class score poorly. The test has high reliability across two forms. What is the concern?

- A. English learners should be excluded from testing.
- B. No concern, because high reliability proves the test is valid.
- C. Validity: the test measures English reading as much as solving equations.
- D. The test is too short.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants a valid test of whether students can solve linear equations, and has English learners in class. Which change best improves validity?

- A. Give the same test twice to check consistency.
- B. Remove all equations and test vocabulary instead.
- C. Add more long word problems so the test is harder.
- D. Use plain language and short contexts so scores reflect equation solving.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

At the end of a lesson on photosynthesis, a teacher in a newly built science wing asks, Does everyone understand? Three students who sit in the front row say yes, and she moves to the next topic. Next day, most of the class fails the quiz. What should she have done?

- A. Used an all-student check, such as a mini-whiteboard question or exit ticket, before moving on.
- B. Called on the same three students with a harder question.
- C. Moved the three students to the back row.
- D. Assumed understanding because students did not ask questions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An algebra teacher who uses a standing desk has students at three readiness levels, all working on writing linear equations from situations. The class is scheduled to take a field trip next month. Which is a tiered assignment?

- A. All groups write equations from situations: one with a partially completed table, one with a standard task, one with a multi-step situation.
- B. Students who need support copy the answers from the key.
- C. Each group plans a different part of the field trip.
- D. Advanced students do 30 problems and others do 10 of the same problems.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A Spanish teacher who studied in Madrid finds that one student can already write sentences in the present tense alone. With a partner and a model, the student can write sentences in the past tense but cannot yet do it alone. The class uses a new digital textbook. Which task is in the student's zone of proximal development?

- A. Writing a full essay in the subjunctive mood alone.
- B. Writing past-tense sentences with a model and partner support.
- C. Writing present-tense sentences alone.
- D. Reading the digital textbook independently.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student solves two-step equations alone but not multi-step ones, even with hints. Which is the best next task?

- A. More two-step equations exactly like before.
- B. Multi-step equations with the same hints.
- C. Two-step equations with variables on both sides, with a worked example.
- D. One-step equations.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A student in a chemistry class that meets in an old portable classroom says, I'm just bad at chemistry. The student has two older siblings who became engineers. According to self-efficacy theory, which approach will most strengthen belief in their ability?

- A. Give only easy tasks so the student always succeeds.
- B. Tell the student repeatedly that they are smart.
- C. Remind the student that siblings became engineers.
- D. Design a sequence of challenging but achievable tasks the student can succeed at.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	----------------------	----------------------------------

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to use vicarious experience, a secondary source of self-efficacy. Which action fits?

- A. Have the teacher, an expert, solve the problem quickly.
- B. Have a classmate at a similar level model solving a problem and explain their thinking.
- C. Have the student solve a challenging problem successfully.
- D. Tell the student they can do it.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	----------------------	----------------------------------

12.

A physics teacher who is known for a popular YouTube channel uses an AI tool to create a 20-question quiz in under a minute. The quiz is well formatted and includes an answer key. He plans to copy and give it the next morning. What should he do first?

- A. Never use AI to create any assessment.
- B. Give it as is, because the format and key look professional.
- C. Share it on his channel for feedback first.
- D. Review every item and the key for accuracy, bias, and alignment with his objectives.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	----------------------	----------------------------------

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A geography teacher ~~who recently earned a master's degree~~ writes the objective: Students will compare the climates of two regions using data. The planned activity is a colorful map-coloring worksheet, and the assessment is a labeling quiz. ~~Students love the worksheet.~~ What is the main problem?

Target word: alignment problem **Decides:** Neither the activity nor the quiz asks students to compare climates with data.

A	Dropped element	More labeling items still do not measure comparison.
B	Inverted operation	Lowers the goal to fit the tasks instead of fixing the tasks.
C	Correct	Both are misaligned with the objective.
D	Camouflage	Enjoyment is not the issue; alignment is.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

An assessment asks students to write a letter to a city council arguing for a policy, using two data sources. Which objective does it align with?

Target word: reverse: from the assessment back to the objective **Decides:** The task is an argument supported with data.

A	Adjacent category	Recall, not argument.
B	Correct	Matches both the skill and the evidence required.
C	Confusion set	Letter format is the vehicle, not the target skill.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out the argument and data.

3. Answer A Concept 2

An art history teacher ~~who spent a summer in Italy~~ asks: Evaluate the painting by listing the three colors the artist used. The question appears ~~on a new district-designed template.~~ At what cognitive level is the task actually working?

Target word: actual cognitive level **Decides:** Listing colors is recall or identification, whatever the verb says.

A	Correct	The task only asks students to identify and list.
B	Adjacent category	Nothing new is produced.
C	Camouflage	The template does not change the task.
D	Confusion set	The verb does not set the level; the task does.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A math teacher ~~who coaches the chess team~~ writes a unit test on solving linear equations. Every item is a long word problem with advanced vocabulary. Many English learners who solve equations correctly in class score poorly. ~~The test has high reliability across two forms.~~ What is the concern?

Target word: validity threat **Decides:** Scores reflect reading ability more than equation solving.

A	Absolute language	Remove the barrier, not the students.
B	Camouflage	A test can be consistent and still measure the wrong thing.
C	Correct	An unrelated skill is shaping scores.
D	Dropped element	Length does not fix a construct problem.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A teacher wants a valid test of whether students can solve linear equations, and has English learners in class. Which change best improves validity?

Target word: fix the validity problem **Decides:** Reduce the reading load that is unrelated to the target skill.

A	Confusion set	That checks reliability, not validity.
B	Dropped element	Drops the skill the test is supposed to measure.
C	Inverted operation	Increases the unrelated reading demand.
D	Correct	Removes construct-irrelevant reading demands.

6. Answer A Concept 4

At the end of a lesson on photosynthesis, a teacher ~~in a newly built science wing~~ asks, Does everyone understand? Three students ~~who sit in the front row~~ say yes, and she moves to the next topic. Next day, most of the class fails the quiz. What should she have done?

Target word: check whole-class understanding **Decides:** Only three volunteers responded.

A	Correct	Gathers evidence from every student.
B	Dropped element	Still leaves most of the class out.
C	Camouflage	Seating is irrelevant to checking understanding.
D	Inverted operation	Silence is not evidence of learning.

7. Answer A Concept 5

An algebra teacher ~~who uses a standing desk~~ has students at three readiness levels, all working on writing linear equations from situations. ~~The class is scheduled to take a field trip next month.~~ Which is a tiered assignment?

Target word: true tiering **Decides:** Same goal, varied complexity or support.

A	Correct	Same goal at different levels of support and complexity.
B	Dropped element	Removes the learning goal.
C	Camouflage	Not tied to the objective.
D	Inverted operation	Tiers by quantity, not complexity.

8. Answer B Concept 6

A Spanish teacher ~~who studied in Madrid~~ finds that one student can already write sentences in the present tense alone. With a partner and a model, the student can write sentences in the past tense but cannot yet do it alone. ~~The class uses a new digital textbook.~~ Which task is in the student's zone of proximal development?

Target word: task in the ZPD **Decides:** Past tense is possible with help but not alone.

A	Absolute language	Too far beyond reach, even with help.
B	Correct	Just beyond independent level, reachable with help.
C	Adjacent category	Already mastered; below the zone.
D	Camouflage	The textbook format is irrelevant.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

A student solves two-step equations alone but not multi-step ones, even with hints. Which is the best next task?

Target word: place the next task in the zone **Decides:** Multi-step is beyond reach now; a step between is needed.

A	Dropped element	Stays at the mastered level.
B	Inverted operation	Already shown to be out of reach even with help.
C	Correct	A reachable step just beyond current independent skill.
D	Confusion set	Moves backward below mastery.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A student in a chemistry class ~~that meets in an old portable classroom~~ says, I'm just bad at chemistry. ~~The student has two older siblings who became engineers.~~ According to self-efficacy theory, which approach will most strengthen belief in their ability?

Target word: strongest source of self-efficacy **Decides:** Mastery experiences build self-efficacy most.

A	Absolute language	Success on easy tasks does not build real efficacy.
B	Adjacent category	Verbal persuasion is a weaker source.
C	Camouflage	Comparison to siblings is not a mastery experience.
D	Correct	Mastery experiences are the strongest source.

11. Answer B Concept 7 • transfer

A teacher wants to use vicarious experience, a secondary source of self-efficacy. Which action fits?

Target word: identify a different source **Decides:** Vicarious experience means watching a similar peer succeed.

A	Dropped element	Leaves out the similarity that makes modeling persuasive.
B	Correct	Seeing a similar peer succeed is vicarious experience.
C	Confusion set	That is a mastery experience.
D	Adjacent category	That is verbal persuasion.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A physics teacher ~~who is known for a popular YouTube channel~~ uses an AI tool to create a 20-question quiz in under a minute. ~~The quiz is well formatted and includes an answer key.~~ He plans to copy and give it the next morning. What should he do first?

Target word: step before using AI output **Decides:** AI output must be checked for accuracy and alignment.

A	Absolute language	AI can help when output is verified.
B	Camouflage	Formatting does not show accuracy.
C	Adjacent category	Public feedback does not replace teacher review.
D	Correct	Polished output can still contain errors.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	8	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Alignment of objective, activity, and assessment	A lesson is aligned when the activity practices and the assessment measures exactly what the objective states.	Choosing an engaging activity that practices a different skill than the objective.	The objective verb and the assessment task do not match.
2	Bloom's revised taxonomy levels	Remember, understand, apply, analyze, evaluate, create; the task, not the verb alone, sets the cognitive level.	Assuming a higher-level verb makes a recall task higher level.	An objective or question must be matched to a level.
3	Validity of an assessment	An assessment is valid for a purpose when its results reflect the skill it claims to measure, not unrelated skills.	Equating a reliable or well-formatted test with a valid one.	A test depends heavily on a skill that is not the target.
4	Checking for understanding with every student	All-student response methods (whiteboards, hinge questions, exit tickets) show what the whole class knows.	Calling on volunteers and treating their answers as class understanding.	Only a few confident students answer.
5	Tiered assignments	Tiered tasks target the same learning goal at different levels of readiness, complexity, or support.	Tiering by quantity: more problems for advanced students.	Students at different readiness levels, one standard.
6	Zone of proximal development	Learning is most productive in tasks a student cannot yet do alone but can do with support (Vygotsky).	Assigning tasks that are either already mastered or far beyond reach even with help.	What a student can do alone vs. with help.
7	Self-efficacy	Mastery experiences, actual success on challenging tasks, are the strongest source of self-efficacy (Bandura).	Relying on praise alone to build confidence.	A student says they are just bad at the subject.
8	Verifying AI-generated materials	AI-generated lessons, quizzes, or facts must be checked for accuracy, bias, and alignment before classroom use.	Assuming AI output is correct because it looks polished.	A teacher plans to use AI output without review.

Course scope (public description): General Secondary Methods prepares students for secondary teaching by equipping them with essential instructional skills and knowledge tailored to adolescent learners. Students will explore how adolescent development influences learning, how secondary school settings influence instructional choices, and how to implement effective teaching strategies in these environments. Through a blend of theory and practical application, students will create and assess lesson plans, focusing on differentiated instruction, formative and summative assessments, and the integration of technology, including AI tools, to promote effective learning in diverse secondary education settings.